

Scene 6-7: Boss Battle - Dorogh

TIME

~25-30 minutes

PURPOSE

Climactic battle • Insight mechanic • Blade moment • Eucatastrophe

CLIMBING TO THRONE ROOM (Brief)

You climb cold stone stairs. Each step heavier. Blade grows colder. At top, massive doors partially open. Through them, a voice - deep, mocking:

'I've been waiting for you.'

Moment to prepare: heal, plan. When ready, push through doors...

THE THRONE ROOM

Magnificent but corrupted. High ceilings, stained glass (dark, cracked), marble pillars (stained with shadow). Everything grand twisted into oppressive.

On ancient throne: DOROGH. Massive - 8 feet tall. Blackened steel armor that drinks light. Horned helm, eyes glowing with cold hatred. Greatsword tall as a man.

He rises slowly, deliberately.

Dorogh:

Children playing at heroes. How many has the Order sent to die before me? Twenty? Fifty? I've lost count. Come then. Let me add you to the pile.

PHASE 1: THE INVINCIBLE GENERAL

Dorogh Phase 1: HP: ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐ Armor: ☐

Shadow Minion 1 (when hit): ☐

Shadow Minion 2 (when hit): ☐

PHASE 1 STATS

Defense: 24 • Attack: 16 • HP: 8 • Armor: Yes

Resistances: ALL except Insight (seems invulnerable)

Summons 2 Shadow Minions (HP 1, Defense 14, Attack 8) when first hit

INITIAL ATTACKS FAIL

When players try Might/Agility/Creation/Wit/Heart:

'Your [weapon/ability] strikes toward Dorogh - but it's like hitting solid stone. The blade bounces off. Nothing touches him.'

Dorogh laughs: 'Is that all? The Order sends children with toys?'

This happens multiple times until someone uses INSIGHT.

IF PLAYERS STUCK

- Remind: Constance's words - 'see through the corruption'
- 'Blade is ice-cold. What is Dorogh hiding?'
- 'Anyone with Insight... you sense something underneath...'

THE INSIGHT MOMENT (The Key)

When someone uses INSIGHT:

'You focus not on his armor or sword, but on HIM. You look past corruption, past hatred, past twisted power.

And you SEE.

For just a moment, shadows flicker. Beneath armor, beneath rage, you see a man. A general who once defended this city.

Who loved its people. Who stood for justice.

And you see what broke him: lies. Drachan's whispers. "They betrayed you. They're weak. Only power matters. Take what you deserve."

The corruption is a shell, and you've found the crack.

Dorogh SCREAMS - not in pain, but fury and... fear?

"DON'T LOOK AT ME LIKE THAT!"

His form shimmers. Shadows weaken. For first time, he looks... vulnerable.'

PHASE 2: THE VULNERABLE GENERAL

Dorogh Phase 2: HP: ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐ Armor: ☐

PHASE 2 STATS

Defense: 20 (lowered) • Attack: 16 • HP: 8 (same) • Armor: Yes (if not broken)

Resistances: Agility only

Minions: Already summoned

THE BLADE'S OPENING

'Shadows part. There - carved into center of his breastplate - a shape, glowing faintly. The exact shape of the Blade of Righteous Judgment.

This is it. This is where the Blade must strike. But you'll need to break through to reach it.'

Dorogh now vulnerable to all attacks except Agility. Armor still must be broken first. More desperate, aggressive.

'You don't understand! I did what I had to! They were weak! I made them strong!'

SHADOW MINIONS

When Dorogh first takes damage: 'Shadows pour from corners, forming two twisted creatures of living darkness.'

HP 1, Defense 14, Attack 8. Weak but distracting.

WHITTILING DOWN DOROGH

As players damage him:

At 6 HP: 'You think you're righteous? You're just pawns of the Order! Tools!'

At 4 HP: 'I was GREAT once! I protected this city! They didn't appreciate it!'

At 2 HP: 'Drachan... promised... power... I just wanted... to be strong enough...'

THE FINAL BLOW

When Dorogh reaches 0 HP:

'Dorogh staggers, falls to one knee. Sword clatters. Shadows almost gone - you see him clearly. Just a man, broken and exhausted.

The opening in his breastplate glows bright. The shape of the Blade.

This is it. Only the Blade can finish this. Only the Blade can break Drachan's hold completely.'

[Blade-bearer], the Blade is warm now. Not cold - warm. It knows what must be done.

Dorogh looks up, eyes clear for first time. Human.

'Do it,' he whispers. 'Please. End this. I... I can't remember who I was anymore. I can't... please...'

[Players can say final words - show mercy even in judgment]

'You raise the Blade. It gleams with clear, true light. You strike.

The Blade pierces the opening perfectly, through armor, through corruption, through lies, straight to his heart.

Dorogh gasps. And then... he smiles.

"Thank you," he breathes. "I remember now. I remember... the gardens. The people. Their laughter. I remember... who I was..."

The shadows shatter like glass. Light floods the throne room - real light, warm and golden. Dorogh's corrupted armor crumbles away. Beneath: just a tired old soldier, finally at peace.

He falls, but gently, like sleep after a long battle.

The curse is broken.'

THE EUCATASTROPHE

'You feel it - the weight lifting. The oppression shattering.

Through windows: the FOG. You hadn't realized it was there - thick gray fog over the city for so long people forgot sunlight.

But now it's dissolving, burning away.

Golden light - real sunlight - pours through windows. Light floods throne room, keep, streets below.

From outside, voices growing louder. Not fear - WONDER.'

[Through windows]: People stepping into streets, looking up at sky in disbelief. Weeping. Laughing. Woman raises face to sun for first time in ages. Old man straightens his bent back, strength returning. Child points and shouts, "The sun! Mother, the SUN!"

As light touches them, color returns to faces. Strength fills limbs. Hope ignites in eyes.

Someone picks up shovel. Someone else grabs hammer. Young man seizes sword from cowering guard.

'DRIVE THEM OUT!' The cry taken up by hundreds: 'DRIVE THEM OUT! DRIVE THEM OUT!'

The uprising begins. Corrupted guards fleeing. Some surrender. Most run. People chase them down, reclaiming their city street by street. The occupying force crumbles.

Doors behind you burst open. Constance, chains broken, blood on sword (not hers). Behind her - an army. Not soldiers. Just people. Armed with whatever they could find. Not afraid anymore.

'You did it,' Constance breathes. 'The moment light hit us, we felt it - strength we forgot we had. Hope we thought was dead.

The corrupted guards are broken without Dorogh. Most are fleeing.'

[Looks at Dorogh's body] 'He was a good man once. Thank you for giving him peace. And thank you for giving us back our sun.'

From streets: singing. Someone started an old song, from before the fall. A song of freedom.'